

Yesterday, We've seen the difference between organism and mechanism, and the relationship of these “entities” with dasein.

Let's go deeper into logos, thinking about what the logos is made of.

Let's consider the idea of truth. How can we define truth? There is something wrong in asking what is truth, as we can ask what the truth is in a given situation, like is it raining or not.

This question assumes that the truth is something already given in front of us. Truth is not a mere fact, but an experience, a calling that has the transformative power to change you, and our perspective on reality.

Truth is more something dynamic than a set of objective data. Assimilating truth to scientific certainty is a modern tendency, arising from man's need to dominate the world, disposing it into a *gestell*, and using it as a *bestand*.

Truths are mostly of a secondary type, we agree on using some criteria like scientific method instead of others. Are there any general criteria to establish what the truth is? There are no absolute ones, since our idea of truth is always connected to the goal we're pursuing, to the question we're asked, and how it's asked.

Every dasein is already provided with given criteria since the day he is born.

Let's think about witches. Their trials were regulated by precise criteria in the 16th century, and this is important as we can always talk about truth in the secondary sense, but we cannot apply their rules to decide what meaning we want to ? through our actions.

In the same way, we cannot establish with scientific criteria what justice is, and how to decide, for example, who should occupy hospital beds in case of disasters, like children, elderly, etc.

If the delegation to machines increases, how can we program these kind of choices?

In short, all the truth that concerns us cannot be demonstrated scientifically.

The truth that we can demonstrate concerns us, but to the sense it can serve us. The horizon of meanings is more complicated. What do we listen to? What is truth for us? The truth is what corresponds to my experience, that is from

hermenutic truth is what is recognized, but cannot be known directly. If we look ourselves in the mirror, we cannot truly see ourselves (?).

What is scandalous about hermeneutics is this: there are no facts, but only interpretations. Fact must be stated by someone, and they cannot speak for themselves. When said there are no facts and no interpretation, we're placed in a perspective that does not depend exclusively on me

*small missing part*

Among different interpretations, what position should we take? If someone ask me if there are witches or vampires, the answer is no, but a test has never been done to verify it, as the historical horizon has worn out, and carrying out this verification is not useful.

Objectivity, seems to be more real, and therefore more persuasive, helping us to agree better.

Meanwhile, in the history of science, we've witnessed various paradigms shift, and in the same era we can see how scientific approach varies.

This confirms that truth is a question of inter-subjective relationships, and even the scientific experiment, expressed through mathematical characters, is always an "argumentum ad hominem". For others who repeat the experiment, if the results is the same, they agree.

Truth is not only a scientific certainty. I cannot describe everything to say the truth, a map identifying the territory should not write everything, but only the most important points.

We have clarified a first point regarding truth: truth and interpretation are not two antithetical concepts, as truth is not opposed to interpretation, but is made up of them. Just like justice, truth is not something that already exists in nature, but has to go through the human work of searching for sensing and meaning, which requires a shared dialogue.

From the beginning, it's also connected to lie. "Veritas" is the naked truth. *myth of truth and lie, about clothes*. Anyone who wishes to find the truth, must be ready to lean in the well, and look deep inside, and thus face the anguish, separating those who travel on the surface of every day inauthenticity, and those who face the up-ground (?), the groundless abyss of nothing. How do we interpret the myth? Lie, when dressed like truth, becomes plausible. Truth, also, causes scandal. A well dressed lie is preferable to a scandalous truth. Lie does not have the courage to enter in the well, but truth does, and in this we can see its transformative action. Truth is calling us, and we should respond to this to distance ourselves from lies. Looking at the bottom of the well makes us see the truth, and together our

reflection on the water, that is our interpretation. The image of those seeking the truth does not disappear, but enter in the picture as a constitutive part (?). The nature of truth is not that of full exposure, of appearance, but that of subtraction. The goddess of truth flees into hiding. This concept is connected to the world the Greek use to say "truth", ἀλήθεια, written as alétheia. Now we have two etymological possibilities, in the first one we derive ἀλήθεια in ἀλή, which means the footsteps, while θεία means the divine footsteps. This meaning of aletheia recalls something dynamic, a path to follow without the pretence of catching what one is chasing, so it's like following the steps of something sacred, a way of observing things that is more contemplative, as we're moving through this reality. This was one of the two possible etymological truths, as the other one is given by ἀ meaning "no", λήθεια coming from a verb (?), that means to be hidden, so "non-hidden". It means to unveil and reveal. Unveiling means to remove the veil, and reveal means to put the veil back. The center of the second etymology is the hiding, and the research activity for truth is not following the footsteps of the sacred path, but rather snatching it from its hiding (?).

As we've seen, this is the technical gaze that human beings lay on everything surrounding them, like nature but also human beings, which are not seen in a contemplative light, for what they appear, but in a manipulative light, so for what they can be used for. Things are part of a man project. The wood is no longer a forest in itself, but is regarded as a Bestand, a reserve for heating, building, etc. This scientific attitude, intensified by IT, embraces the paradigm of bringing truth out of hiding.

Let's take fake news for example. On internet, our ego is compelled to reveal itself through the voluntary (and not) sharing of personal data, as a condition to live in the network. We've thrived to live in the world, and turn it into content. Transparency stands as the phenomenological opposite of appearance, while appearance is offered to our vision, transparency aims to break through the surface, exposing it from the inside.

For Heidegger, this procedure of unveiling the truth, without then revealing, is a violent way of treating it, and this violence is without care, intended as *nachsicht*, so a benevolent approach, coming closer to the other, and without *rücksicht*, that is a step backwards, a respectful distancing from the other.

This idea of truth as full exposition is opposed to the Heideggerian idea of truth, as "radura", "lichtung", "clearing". What is a clearing? When we're walking in the wood, and the vegetation is thick enough, it blocks us from seeing through. At a certain point, light filters through the vegetation, and illuminates a bit of the path. In a clearing, we get a cleaner view.

Human beings move through a veil of unknown and mystery, and in such a condition truth cannot be a blinding total exposure, rather an illuminating opening.

"light" means also "leggero", the act of lightening is also of making space.

Light illuminates such that a thing can be seen, and the clearing makes space for it to appear. In Heidegger's view, truth is not something already given to be found, rather an activity of interpretation of hermeneutics. This idea of truth is far from today's declination of truth, which is linked to the idea of transparency.

Transparency has been elevated as a value, presented as a formula capable of ensuring a more efficient life. Yet, contrary to its democratic promise, transparency has become an instrument of control in the hands of corporations and governments.

Surveillance and technology enshapes behaviour, while the illusion of transparency conceals the real structure of power at play. Users are encouraged to share every aspect of their life, producing a digital environment where individuals submit to constant exposures, in pursuit of validation, and this is where the surveillance takes root and rise.

In such a society, genuine human connection becomes increasingly rare, the constant performance of the self leaves no space for empathy, while it encourages competition and shame. Showing everything can be exposed removes the meaning out of it. Something can be transparent only if it's empty. Let's consider all the narratives that constitute the heritage that symbolically ? the generation, and transmits the culture and spirit, that our parents address to us, and only to us.

Today, narratives and stories have moved online, having digital stories. They are crafted by strangers, sharing their experience and become familiar to us, even without they've encountered our existence. They enter our daily life through information, yet the narratives they offer are far from authentic. Why are they different? As they're always driven by a commercial intent. This act of sharing loses its meaning, that is the mutual participation into another's existence.

Instead, it becomes an ephemeral preference, reduced to a one way transmission of content. It is clear that the fact of communication is in the hands of the masses, also has a positive aspect. However, an increase in information does not necessarily lead to better information, and sometimes all these information noises end up paralyzing our faculty of judgement. The large amount of information does not produce any truth, shedding a light in the darkness, rather it becomes darkness itself.

From a certain point information is no longer informative, but deformative, flattened in platforms.

Let's think about fake news: here the purpose is not communicative, but addictive.

Fake news are not lies, they're much more dangerously indifferent to the reality of facts. The crisis of truth that we're witnessing today, cannot be traced back to the discrepancy between knowledge and facts. Generative AI can create content perfectly limiting reality, leading us to doubt what we see. In this digital "panopticon" (?) no trust is possible, and therefore not even necessary.

A panopticon is a prison with multiple cells, having inside prisoners, who cannot communicate with one-another, and since the structure is circular, there is only one soldier to watch over all of them. Digital panopticon works differently. We have the soldier, but people are not divided by walls, and are encouraged to communicate, to catch more data.

In this structure, no trust is possible, and not even necessary. It becomes an obsolete as information is already available online.

Total control is made possible not by spatial and communicative isolation, but by network connections and hyper communication. The inhabitants of this panopticon don't feel like they are prisoners, living in the illusion of freedom, and they feed the panopticon with information, exposing and illuminating themselves, adopting a form of self exploitation. This is more effective than exploitation exercised by others, as it's associated with a feeling of freedom.